



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2022-23
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II (Set A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

The paper has four sections.

Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.

You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from any section of your choice.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

i) The author of the story *The Little Match Girl* is:

- a) Hans Anderson Christian
- b) Robert Browning
- c) T. S. Arthur
- d) Hans Christian Andersen

ii) What was the first vision of the Little Match Girl?

- a) Her loving and gentle grandmother
- b) A brass stove decorated with iron knobs and brass ornaments
- c) A great iron stove with brass knobs and brass ornaments
- d) Shining white cloth spread on the table covered with beautiful china and in the centre of the table stood a roast goose

iii) Joe Thompson couldn't take Maggie to the poorhouse that day because:

- a) He wanted to keep her with himself.
- b) The permission of the Guardians had to be obtained.
- c) The villagers did not want her to go there.
- d) Maggie had requested Joe not to take her there.

iv) The food that Jane gave Maggie was:

- a) Slice of bread softened with tea and biscuits.
- b) Toasted slice of bread softened with tea and butter and a cup of milk.
- c) Slice of bread softened with milk and butter and a cup of tea.
- d) Toasted Slice of bread softened with milk and butter and a cup of tea.

v) Which of the following sentence is TRUE about the crocodile that Norah Burke talks about in her story *The Blue Bead*?

- a) He was twice the length of a tall man and had swallowed a gold bracelet to aid digestion.
- b) He was twice the length of a tall man and had swallowed a bracelet to aid digestion.
- c) He was twice the length of a tall man and had swallowed stones to aid digestion.
- d) He was twice the length of a tall man, had managed to escape the birds of prey and fed on baby crocodiles.

vi) What can the caged bird seldom see through?

- a) Grave of Dreams
- b) Rage
- c) Bars of Rage
- d) Nightmarish scream

vii) How does the free bird leap?

- a) On the back of the wind.**
- b) Does not leap at all.**
- c) Downstream till the current ends.**
- d) On the back of the trade winds.**

viii) Identify the correct theme of the poem, *The Patriot*.

- a) Fickleness of the leaders**
- b) Loyalty of the followers**
- c) Optimism**
- d) Unity in Diversity**

ix) The fat worms are waiting on ____.

- a) Bright lawns.**
- b) Dawn bright lawns.**
- c) Where the current ends.**
- d) Nowhere.**

x) Who are throwing stones at the patriot?

- a) His followers who had once cheered for him.**
- b) The palsied few.**
- c) His best friends who had plotted his execution because he was ambitious.**
- d) The members of the opposite party.**

xi) *I'll follow him no more with bootless prayers.* Who says these words and about whom?

- a) Bassanio says about Shylock**
- b) The Duke says about Antonio**
- c) Antonio says about Shylock**
- d) Portia says about Shylock**

- xii) What excuse does Portia give to Lorenzo when she is about to leave for the Court in Venice to save Antonio?
- a) That she will repent for her sins in a monastery two miles off.
 - b) That she has taken a secret vow to pray for the safety of Antonio.
 - c) That she has taken a secret vow to live in prayer and contemplation alone in a monastery.
 - d) That she has taken a secret vow to live in prayer and contemplation attended only by Nerissa in a monastery.
- xiii) *Shylock : Gaoler, Look to him: tell not me of mercy*
Who is referred to as 'him'?
- a) Bassanio
 - b) Salerio
 - c) Solanio
 - d) Antonio
- xiv) According to Launcelot, what is Lorenzo guilty of?
- a) Marrying a Jew.
 - b) Being responsible for increasing the price of pork.
 - c) Not doing enough to save the life of Antonio.
 - d) Partnering with Jessica to rob Shylock.
- xv) What does Bassanio compare his situation to when Portia asks him to spend more time with her?
- a) Rack.
 - b) Person upon the rack
 - c) Friendship between Snow and fire
 - d) Enmity between Treason and his love for Portia
- xvi) *There I have another bad match-*. Identify the speaker.
- a) Portia
 - b) Antonio
 - c) Jessica
 - d) Shylock

SECTION B
DRAMA (The Merchant of Venice- Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Shylock: Out upon her! Thou torturest me, Tubal: it was
my turquoise; I had of Leah when I was a
bachelor: I would not give it for a wilderness of monkeys.*

- i) Where is this scene taking place? Who is 'her'? On what has 'her' spent 'my turquoise'? [3]
- ii) According to Salerio, how is 'her' and Shylock different? What was Solanio's reply when Shylock accuses him of knowing the plan of 'her' beforehand? [3]
- iii) What happy news has Tubal just given Shylock? Why does this news make Shylock happy? What does he wish for 'her' in the presence of Tubal? [3]
- iv) What instructions does Shylock give Tubal immediately after the above speech? What good will Antonio's flesh do for Shylock? [3]
- v) List any three ways in which Antonio has wronged Shylock. What is your impression about Shylock from this scene? [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Duke: I am sorry for thee. Thou art come to answer
A stony adversary, an inhuman wretch
Uncapable of pity, void and empty
From any dram of mercy.*

- i) Who is the 'stony adversary'? Who is the Duke speaking to? Where is this scene taking place? [3]
- ii) Who is Portia dressed as? Who had helped Portia to deliver the letter to her cousin in Padua? What instructions had Portia given to Lorenzo before leaving her mansion? [3]
- iii) What does Portia say about the quality of Mercy? [3]
- iv) What three examples does Antonio give to illustrate that it is useless to reason with Shylock? [3]
- v) What is Shylock proven guilty of? What punishment does Antonio pronounce upon Shylock towards the end of the Trial scene? Which punishment of Shylock do you dislike? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

SECTION C
PROSE- SHORT STORIES
(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

She had paused, amazed, before the sweetmeat stall, to gaze at the brilliant honey confections, abuzz with dust and flies. They smelled wonderful, above the smells of drains and humanity and cheap cigarettes.

- i) Who is 'she'? What was she dressed in? Describe her meal. [3]
- ii) Where was the bazaar? Who had accompanied her to the bazaar? What did they have to pass through to reach the bazaar? [3]
- iii) How was 'she' from birth to death marked for work? [3]
- iv) Who were the 'Gujars'? What did they wear? [3]
- v) Why did 'she' accompany her mother everyday? How does the author contrast the situation of toiling women to the agent? What reward does 'she' get at the end of the story? [4]

Question 5

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

Then he wrapped her with the gentleness almost of a woman, in the clean bedclothes which some neighbour had brought; and, lifting her in his strong arms, bore her out into the air and across the field...

- i) Who is 'he'? What was his profession? What did he do for the children of the village? [3]
- ii) Name 'her'. Why couldn't 'her' walk? [3]
- iii) Name and describe the siblings of 'her'. Who were they taken away by? [3]
- iv) How did the mother of 'her' die? What were the evil qualities of the mother of 'her'? [3]
- v) What kind of a person was the wife of 'he'? How did she react when 'her' was brought to their home? Comment on the title of the story with suitable textual examples. [4]

SECTION D
POETRY
(Treasure Trove- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*I go in rain, and, more than needs,
A rope cuts both my wrists behind...*

- i) Who is 'I'? Where is he being taken? [3]
- ii) Why is 'I' being punished? What had 'I' dared to do? [3]
- iii) How was 'I' welcomed a year ago? [3]
- iv) What would have the followers of 'I' agreed to give him a year ago? How do they treat him now? [3]
- v) How does 'I' believe that God will judge him? How was the weather on the day that 'I' was being taken? Who were at the window sill? Which philosophy did Browning believe in? [4]

Question 7

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*A free bird leaps
On the back of the wind
And floats downstream
till the current ends.*

- i) Who does the free bird symbolise? What does it name its own? What does it think about? [3]
- ii) Which other kind of bird is being spoken about? Who does this bird symbolise? Where does this bird stalk? [3]
- iii) Explain the phrase 'grave of dreams'. How does the other bird protest? [3]
- iv) Why is the 'trill' of the other bird fearful? What is the song about? Where is it heard? [3]
- v) How is the other bird treated? Give one suitable theme of the poem. Justify. [4]